

Appendix XXX - Details regarding the 'refund' processs

Bills involved in the 'refund' process

It is necessary to examine at least three bills to begin to understand the refund process.

These are:

1. octopus-energy-statement-2025-06-30 (the bill headlines as: 29th June 2025 - 30th June 2025)

This bill seems - in terms of 'billing periods' at least - to deal with dates between

- 1 October 2024 (earliest), and
- July 15 2025 (latests).

The 'we have credited you' does mention 30th June (three times in large text) and bill expands upon my apparent balance on July 29 and then on July 30. No details are given of the balance in the 'in-between' time!

Neither July 29 nor July 30 correspond to any of the six date ranges relating to the credit/debit activity shown.

This bill both credits the customer, then charges them for periods overlapping the credited periods - but which do not match exactly. Date ranges apparently thought appropriate for previous bills (see latter two bills) and changed. It is unclear why - this just adds to a growing sense of confusion and unease, culminating in the clearly subjective feeling that @someone is trying to pull the wool over eyes." Please note this is in no way an accusation - I am merely stating how it made me *feel*.

To top it off, the bill also introduces a new charge for what seems like a previously unbilled period. I cannot confirm this, however, as given the gaps in date ranges common in Octopus bills - I'd have to read all 70 or so of them and blot out time ranges on a calendar to be absolutely sure. Unfortunately, though I spent a considerable amount of time over a four week period investigating various details - I could not actually face doing that.

Being completely open, it is very difficult for me to with 100% certainty exactly what is going on in these bills.

They are the product of the Octopus refund process. And despite my efforts to engage - they have just completely 'blanked' my attempts to get any form of constructive dialog going - and get a firm grip on what they have actually done.

I'd therefore request the FOS seek Octopus input directly in the hope of fully clarifying matters. I certainly wish I could have had their assistance. It would have saved me a huge amounts of time, effort and putting it bluntly, stress.

1. octopus-energy-statement-2024-12-31 in the hope of fully clarifying matters-1
2. octopus-energy-statement-2025-03-29 (partially-refunded-bill-2).

The latter two bills shown here are provided as the credits shown in the bill discussed above clearly reference *parts* of them. **Parts** as there are equally clearly other parts not referenced. However they do contain all the referenced time-periods/amounts shown in the credit region.

From this I it seems reasonable to conclude that:

- Confusing details aside, Octopus have decided that whole of the 'over-estimate' was made in a six month period before a couple of months before the refund was 'issued.'
- Within this time period unit rates per kWh were in the order of 6p or just above.
- That Octopus decision to place the whole over-estimate within this period is completely arbitrary and does not correlate with their own annual usage estimates - which have been consistently high since 2022.
- That were this in fact correct, the house usage of gas would have had to drop from XXX kWh per day in 2023 to XXX kWh during the chosen period.
- That as it stands I have suffered a not-insubstantial financial loss in terms of what I paid for units, and what I got back for those I never actually used in the first place.
- And that this whole process has been made infinitely worse by the fact that Octopus have refused to engage or assist me in any manner.